

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 2219

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

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PRESENTED BY:

***Kathleen R. LaNatra***

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*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act expanding access to mental health services and strengthening risk assessment protocols.

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PETITION OF:

| NAME:                         | DISTRICT/ADDRESS:                  | DATE ADDED:      |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------|
| <i>Kathleen R. LaNatra</i>    | <i>12th Plymouth</i>               | <i>1/15/2025</i> |
| <i>Michelle L. Badger</i>     | <i>1st Plymouth</i>                | <i>2/9/2025</i>  |
| <i>Michael D. Brady</i>       | <i>Second Plymouth and Norfolk</i> | <i>2/6/2025</i>  |
| <i>Patrick Joseph Kearney</i> | <i>4th Plymouth</i>                | <i>2/3/2025</i>  |
| <i>Michael O. Moore</i>       | <i>Second Worcester</i>            | <i>3/6/2025</i>  |
| <i>Jeffrey N. Roy</i>         | <i>10th Norfolk</i>                | <i>9/18/2025</i> |
| <i>Steven George Xiarhos</i>  | <i>5th Barnstable</i>              | <i>10/6/2025</i> |

# HOUSE . . . . . No. 2219

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By Representative LaNatra of Kingston, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 2219) of Kathleen R. LaNatra and others for legislation to expand access to mental health services and strengthen risk assessment protocols. Mental Health, Substance Use and Recovery.

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## The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

\_\_\_\_\_  
In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court  
(2025-2026)  
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An Act expanding access to mental health services and strengthening risk assessment protocols.

*Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:*

1           SECTION 1. Section 12 of chapter 123 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2020  
2   Official Edition, is hereby amended by striking out subsection (a) and inserting in place thereof  
3   the following subsection:-

4           (a) A physician who is licensed pursuant to section 2 of chapter 112, an advanced  
5   practice registered nurse authorized to practice as such under regulations promulgated pursuant  
6   to section 80B of said chapter 112, a qualified psychologist licensed pursuant to sections 118 to  
7   129, inclusive, of said chapter 112, a licensed independent clinical social worker licensed  
8   pursuant to sections 130 to 137, inclusive, of said chapter 112, or a licensed mental health  
9   counselor licensed pursuant to section 165 of chapter 112 who, after examining a person and  
10   evaluating the risk of serious harm, has reason to believe that failure to hospitalize such person  
11   would create a likelihood of serious harm to themselves or others by reason of mental health  
12   issues may restrain or authorize the restraint of such person and apply for the hospitalization of

such person for a 3-day period at a public facility or at a private facility authorized for such purposes by the department. If an examination is not possible because of the emergency nature of the case and because of the refusal of the person to consent to such examination, the physician, qualified psychologist, qualified advanced practice registered nurse, licensed independent clinical social worker or licensed mental health counselor on the basis of the facts and circumstances may determine that hospitalization is necessary and may therefore apply. In an emergency situation, if a physician, qualified psychologist, qualified advanced practice registered nurse, licensed independent clinical social worker or licensed mental health counselor is not available, a police officer who believes that failure to hospitalize a person would create a likelihood of serious harm to self or others may restrain such person and apply for an evaluation of the need for hospitalization of such person for a 3-day period at a public facility or a private facility authorized for such purpose by the department. An application for an evaluation of the need for hospitalization shall state the reasons for the referral and possible restraint of such person and any other relevant information related to the degree of risk for serious harm to self or others that may assist the admitting physician or qualified advanced practice registered nurse. Whenever practicable, prior to transporting such person, the applicant shall telephone or otherwise communicate with a facility to describe the circumstances and known clinical history and to determine whether the facility is the proper facility to receive such person and to give notice of any restraint to be used and to determine whether such restraint is necessary.

SECTION 3. Section 22 of said chapter 123, as so appearing, is hereby amended by inserting after the words “police officers” in line 3 the following words:- , licensed mental health counselors.

35           SECTION 4. Said section 22 of said chapter 123, as so appearing, is hereby further  
36 amended by inserting after the words “police officer” in line 9 the following words:- licensed  
37 mental health counselor.